

Recognize it

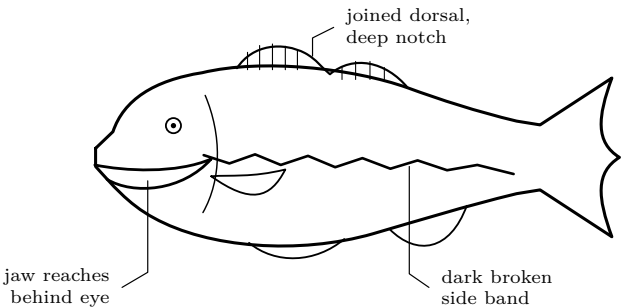
Green bass with dark lateral band; closed jaw extends beyond rear of eye.

Body	Deep-bodied; first and second dorsal sections separated by a deep notch.
Mouth/fins	Very large mouth; tongue lacks a tooth patch.
Confusion	Smallmouth jaw ends near mid-eye and usually shows vertical bars.

Lake role

Where it belongs Vegetation, wood, docks, shade, and nearby depth.
Food and season Fish, crayfish, and large invertebrates; shallow around warming cover, deeper or shaded in heat.

Identification plate



Find it on these waters

Pine	Test protected vegetation and shade, then the deep edge in clear midday conditions.
North	Test weed flats, wood, narrows, and current-adjacent ambush edges.
Evidence	The DNR lake records sometimes name only a broad group such as panfish. In that case this species is a candidate member, not verified individual presence. Confirm presence before targeting; treat locations as testable habitat hypotheses, not abundance findings.

Presentations

- 1. **Weightless plastic.** Skip or pitch to holes and shade; let it fall on slack line and watch for movement.
- 2. **Texas rig.** Probe dense cover with enough weight for bottom contact, not more.
- 3. **Stop rule.** After several accurate casts without evidence, change cover type or depth before changing lure details.

HANDLING DECIDES THE OUTCOME

Land promptly, wet hands, support larger fish horizontally, and never hang a heavy fish by the jaw.

Water-specific rule	May 2, 2026–Mar 7, 2027; 14-in minimum; bass daily bag 5 combined on both lakes.
Kitchen choice	If harvested, favor a legal mid-size fish over a scarce trophy; larger adults are valuable spawners.
Before the trip	Open the Wisconsin DNR water-specific regulation page for WBIC 779200 (Pine) or 850800 (North). Check the exact water, species, and date; the live rule controls if this dated sheet differs.

Keep only a fish you can use

Decide before the cast. Bring ice, stop fishing when the planned meal is secured, and use the species-specific cooking guide for dispatch, bone layout, and safe preparation. Large old predators are valuable spawners and generally carry more mercury than smaller fish.

Sources checked 2026-07-26. Wisconsin DNR lake fish records (Pine WBIC 779200; North WBIC 850800), Wisconsin’s Fishes, Hook Your Catch, 2026–27 water-specific regulations, Catch-and-release Guidelines, and Eating Your Catch. Biological and tactical synthesis is editorial; it is not a current population survey.

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